

BYLAWS of *Theta Lambda* CHAPTER

Adopted: October 30th, 1997

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ARTICLE I – NAME

The name of this chapter shall be the Theta Lambda Chapter of Sigma Alpha Iota, located at Furman University in Greenville, South Carolina.

ARTICLE II - GENERAL PROVISIONS

Section 1. General Policies and Procedures. Any Fraternity procedures or obligations, either chapter or individual, which are not specifically defined in these Bylaws, shall be handled in accordance with established procedures as prescribed in appropriate Fraternity publications.

Section 2. Abbreviations. The following abbreviations shall be used as appropriate throughout these bylaws:

CPM – Chapter Procedures Manual
GPA – Grade Point Average
VPM- Vice President Membership
VPR-Vice President Ritual
MIT-Member in Training

ARTICLE III – MEMBERSHIP

Section 1. Eligibility Requirements for Student Membership.

- A. Membership is open to any woman student who has completed at least one semester of study at Furman University.
- B. A Prospective Member-in-Training must have a sincere interest in music and be willing to uphold the ideals of Sigma Alpha Iota.
- C. A Prospective Member-in-Training must have completed or be currently enrolled in one or more courses in music.
- D. The minimum, overall cumulative grade point average required for membership is 2.5.

Section 2. Title IX Status and Statement Against Discrimination.

- A. Sigma Alpha Iota is a Title IX exempt organization. Sigma Alpha Iota does not discriminate against women students on the basis of race, color, national origin, religion, creed, political belief, disability, age, marital status, veteran status, or sexual orientation.

Section 3. Exception to Active Membership. A member may become locally inactive for one semester.

- A. A member must submit a written request for inactive status at the beginning of the semester for approval.
- B. Reasons for inactive status shall include, but not be limited to: student teaching away from campus; study abroad; internship; financial issues; medical issues; family issues; class conflicts; work conflicts.
- C. Other extenuating circumstances will be considered as they arise.
- D. While inactive, a member is responsible for national dues, but local dues may be waived.
- E. An inactive member may not vote, may not hold office, may not serve on committees or serve as a committee chairman, may not be a sponsor for a Member-in-Training, may not participate in ritual ceremonies. Special permission is required to be eligible for fraternity or chapter honors and awards.
- F. All inactive members are encouraged to attend chapter musicales, ritual ceremonies and other designated public events as an audience member when invited.

Section 4. Financial Obligations of Membership.

- A. All members must pay annual dues in a timely manner to be in good financial standing.
- B. Members who have not met their financial obligations in full by the end of the fraternity year will be considered a member not-in-good-standing and will be reported to National Headquarters as delinquent.

Section 5. Voting Privileges of Membership.

- A. Only members in good standing may vote on chapter business.
- B. To be in good standing, a member must:
 - 1. Pay all dues and fees in full by the set due date.
 - 2. Attend all chapter meetings and events, unless excused.
 - 3. Maintain a 2.5 GPA, the minimum GPA required by local school regulations for active participation in extra-curricular activities.

Section 6. Alumnae Member Status. Members are granted alumnae status upon graduation, termination of studies, or special request and are encouraged to join the Sigma Alpha Iota Alumnae Association and to affiliate with a local alumnae chapter.

ARTICLE IV – MEMBER-IN-TRAINING

- Section 1. Invitations to Membership. After all membership eligibility criteria are met, invitations to membership are issued upon a two-thirds affirmative vote of the chapter in accordance with the CPM.
- Section 2. Sponsors. Each Member-in-Training will have a sponsor.
- A. Service as a sponsor shall be voluntary.
 - B. Sponsors are responsible for assisting and advising the Members-in-Training, ensuring that they fulfill the requirements for initiation into the Fraternity and preparing them to meet the responsibilities and expectations of membership.
- Section 3. Requirements for Initiation. To be initiated into the Fraternity, a Member-in-Training must:
- A. Pay all fees in full by the set due date.
 - B. Demonstrate her musical ability by participating in a membership performance. This participation requirement may be fulfilled by a performance as a soloist, as a member of an ensemble, or, if not a performer, by a demonstration of her interest in and knowledge of music.
 - C. Pass the National Membership Examination.
 - D. Fulfill the requirements of the National and Chapter Member-in-Training program.
- Section 4. Fees.
- A. The Member-in-Training fee must be paid in full at the time of the Pledging Ceremony. This fee is not refundable.
 - B. The initiation fee, which includes the life leasehold of an official member Badge, must be paid in full at the time of the National Membership Examination.
- Section 5. Statement Against Hazing.
- A. Sigma Alpha Iota condemns the hazing of prospective initiates, and Theta Lambda chapter will neither conduct nor participate in hazing activities of any kind.

ARTICLE V – OFFICERS

- Section 1. Elected Officers. The elected officers of the chapter shall be: President; Vice President, Membership; Vice President, Ritual; Corresponding Secretary; Recording Secretary; Treasurer; Sergeant-at-Arms; and Editor.
- Section 2. Duties of Officers. Duties of officers are as listed in the CPM.
- Section 3. Term Length of Offices.
- A. The term of office begins with the installation of officers and ends after a term of 1 year or when the new officers are installed.
 - B. If the nominating committee wishes to consider the current president or treasurer for a second term of office, the committee must first obtain permission, as outlined in the CPM, prior to placing her name on the slate of officers.

- Section 4. Vacancies in Office. Vacancies in office will be filled in accordance with the procedures outlined in the CPM.

ARTICLE VI - NOMINATIONS AND ELECTIONS

- Section 1. Qualifications for Election. To be elected to office a member must:
- A. Be current in the payment of dues and fees.
 - B. Attend all chapter meetings and events, unless excused.
 - C. Maintain the minimum GPA required by local school regulations for active participation in extra-curricular activities and to hold office.
 - D. All Presidential Candidates are recommended to have prior leadership experience and familiarity for the workings of the Executive Board.
 - E. Each candidate is recommended to be available for the entire school year of which she wishes to serve on the Executive Board.
- Section 2. Nominating Committee. A nominating committee of 5 members shall be elected by the chapter in accordance with the CPM.
- Section 3. Nominations. Nominations will be conducted in accordance with the procedures outlined in the CPM.
- Section 4. Elections. Elections will be conducted in accordance with the procedures outlined in the CPM.

ARTICLE VII - EXECUTIVE BOARD

- Section 1. Membership. The executive board shall be composed of all elected chapter officers.
- Section 2. Responsibilities. Duties of the executive board are as outlined in the CPM.
- Section 3. Meetings.
- A. The executive board should meet before each Formal Business Meeting in accordance with the CPM
 - B. The executive board is to meet five times each year with the advisory committee in accordance with the CPM.
- Section 4. Quorum. Quorum shall be designated as a simple majority of the chapter's executive board membership.

ARTICLE VIII – MEETINGS

- Section 1. Chapter Meetings. Chapter meetings are business meetings that are held at regular times.
- A. Formal business meetings must take place at least once each month and must include ritual. Appropriate business attire is required.

- B. Informal chapter meetings shall take place on weeks when there is no formal business meeting.
- C. Quorum shall be designated as two-thirds of the chapter's members-in-good-standing.

Section 2. Special Meetings. Special meetings are meetings of the entire chapter held for emergency purposes, for business that could not be planned for in advance but must be transacted before the next scheduled meeting.

- A. A special meeting can be called by the chapter president or by 4 chapter members.
- B. The Executive Board may call special meetings. Meetings may be called if an emergency arises that must be addressed with the chapter outside of normal meetings or if a rehearsal is necessary for ritual. Notification of the meeting must be made at least 72 hours in advance.

ARTICLE IX – COMMITTEES

Section 1. Standing Committees. Standing committees are ongoing committees that have continuing responsibilities throughout the year.

- A. Standing committees of the chapter include: Social, Membership, Program, Ritual, Yearbook directory, Sisterhood, Fraternity Education, Archives/Scrapbook, Fundraising, National Philanthropy, Local Outreach, Publicity, Receptions, and Song Leader.
- B. The Executive Board shall appoint committee chairmen.
- C. The President shall assign each member to a committee based on individual member preferences and past experiences.
- D. Each committee will consist of a chair and at least one other member
- E. Duties of the committees are as listed in the CPM.
- F. The term of office for committee chairmen is 1 year per the CPM.

Section 2. Special Committees. Special committees may be created by the chapter as needed to function until completion of a specified assignment. These committees include, but are not limited to, Bylaws, Nominating, Honors Committees, and Homecoming.

Section 3. Ex-Officio Committee Membership. The President shall serve as an ex-officio member on all committees except for the Nominating Committee.

ARTICLE X – CHAPTER ADVISORS/ADVISORY COMMITTEE

Section 1. Faculty Advisor. Every chapter is required to have a faculty advisor.

Section 2. Advisory Committee. An advisory committee shall be formed in accordance with the CPM.

Section 3. Meetings. The advisor(s) shall meet at least once each semester by themselves and with the executive board bi-monthly in accordance with the CPM.

Section 4. Responsibilities. Responsibilities and duties of advisors are as outlined in the CPM.

ARTICLE XI - HONORS AND AWARDS

- Section 1. Honors Committee. The chapter president will appoint an Honors Committee of three members in January in accordance with the CPM. Duties of the Honors Committee shall be as outlined in the CPM.
- Section 2. National Honors and Awards. The Chapter may present National Honors and Awards in accordance with the National Bylaws and the CPM.
- Section 3. Local Honors and Awards. The chapter may present local awards with the approval of the Province Officer as long as they do not resemble national awards in name and form.

ARTICLE XII-PARLIAMENTARY AUTHORITY

The rules contained in the current edition of *Robert's Rules of Order, Newly Revised* shall govern the chapter in all cases to which they are applicable and in which they are not inconsistent with these Bylaws and any special rules of order the chapter may adopt.

ARTICLE XIII - AMENDMENT OF BYLAWS

Amendments to these Bylaws may be proposed in writing at any regular meeting and voted upon at a second meeting held at least 48 hours later. A two-thirds affirmative vote of the chapter members in-good-standing is required.